

Roads Beneath the World

A Fate's Edge Sourcebook for Deep Cultures, Dark Economies, and Survival Under Stone

Contents

I. Peoples & Politics Below	2
Lethai-ar — Courts of Web & Scale	2
Aeler — Holds of Stone & Ledger	3
Mazereth — Pressure Guilds & Root-Warrens	3
II. Geography & Economies of Depth	3
III. Procedures Under Stone	4
IV. Etiquette & Law (Position wins)	5
V. Faction Play	5
Lethai-ar Courts	5
Aeler Holds	5
Mazereth Syndics	5
Drake Dominions	5
VI. Bestiary (with stat blocks)	5
Bestiary (with stat blocks)	5
VII. Strings & Diamonds (carry these)	6
Strings & Diamonds	6
VIII. Example of Play (one page)	7
IX. Adventure Seeds	7
X. Running Depth at the Table (cheats)	7
Appendix A: Runekeeper Build (Clockwork Monad)	9
Appendix B: Inaea & Isoka Fanatics (Optional Module)	12

DESIGN GOALS

- **Lived Underground** Make depth a culture, not just a map—air, light, pressure, and custom matter as much as steel.
- **Courts, Not Caves** Replace "monster holes" with societies that negotiate: web-law tribunals, keystone charters, pressure guilds.
- **Simple, Scary Procedures** Survival tracks (Air/Light/Noise/Pressure) drive fiction without new math.
- **Seams to the Surface** Plug cleanly into Political Intrigue, Shadows & Steel, Wilderness, Caravans, and Psionics.

QUICKSTART (2 MINUTES)

1. **Pick a Route Type** Keystone Road (Aeler), Pressure Way (Mazereth), Web-Law Lane (Lethai-ar), Drift-River (underwater/boat), or Raw Vein (wild).
2. **Track Four Things** Air [6], Light [6], Noise [4], Pursuit/Attention [6] (choose drakes, patrols, or hazards).
3. **Intent Dial (per leg)** Stealth / Speed / Survey / Communion (parley with place-spirits). It changes your default Position.
4. **Strings to Carry** keystone courtesies, bell-wire, toll-chalk, web token, shed-skin writ, pressure map, reed charm.
5. **Etiquette On Entry** Step on stone; speak under beam; ring once. (Grants Position +1 in first scene if observed.)

I. PEOPLES & POLITIES BELOW

Lethai-ar — Courts of Web & Scale

Wood-kin sworn to Inae (the Weaver) or Isoka (the Serpent Queen), ruling shadow-vales, web-bridges, and mirror chambers.

- **Doctrine** Order through context. Oaths are woven, not hammered; a clause can be as binding as a chain.
- **Marks** Animist skin-script that enhances sense/body—older ones can slip "out of season" and behave as Curses until recontexted.
- **War** Asymmetric. Light discipline, kill-lanes, denial of approach; they prefer deterrence to slaughter. Most peoples leave them alone.
- **Etiquette** Candle-right (never blow out another's light); Web-Law token gains DV 1 in courtly scenes; Shed-Skin rite (Isoka) forgives one past identity in exchange for a future favor.
- **Strings** Web-Token (enter parley anywhere their silk is anchored), Shed-Skin Writ (voids 1 coercive clause once), Hedge-Pass (move unseen on a marked ledge, once/leg).

Aeler — Holds of Stone & Ledger

Mountain folk whose under-roads and keystone works keep nations standing. Underground to them is survival horror with accounting.

- **Orders**
 - Iron Avengers: feud-keepers; make blood ledgers balance.
 - Spirit Shield Warriors: ancestor rites + corridor defense.
 - True Masons: wandering repair crews (Acasia, Vhasia, Viterra).
 - Edgewalkers: coin-hungry rogues in the seams of law.
- **Politics** Collectivist, mercantile, pre-colonial soft power: your display equals what you've delivered to the common works. Many oppose human exploitation and live in foothills and cities.
- **Etiquette** Keystone Courtesy (touch stone, name the builder if known); Public Weights (declare said/meant).
- **Strings** Keystone Seal (close a passage behind you once), Display Writ (Position +1 when invoking public works), Stone-Oath Witness (turn a duel into arbitration).

Mazereth — Pressure Guilds & Root-Warrens

Deep tunnelers (a subculture of the Aelinnel "People of Sums") who live by math and marrow: pressure shafts, root-veins, earthen acoustics.

- **Traits** Medium-small; +1 die underground; Pressure Adaptation. Gifts: Deep Earthen Sense, Tunnel Craft, Pressure Resistance, Pattern Reading.
- **Costs** Surface sickness; Lantern Sway (SB: bright light causes missteps).
- **Customs** Counting-breaths, toll-chalk tallies, bell-wire message lines.
- **Strings** Pressure Map (DV 1 to navigate collapses), Bell-Wire Tap (hear "ahead"), Tally-Chalk (prove dues paid at a junction).

II. GEOGRAPHY & ECONOMIES OF DEPTH

Road Types

- **Keystone Roads (Aeler)** mortared galleries, air chimneys, counted lantern niches (repairable).
- **Pressure Ways (Mazereth)** breath-matched shafts, root-arches, drip ledges (readable).
- **Web-Law Lanes (Lethai-ar)** silk bridges, mirror turns, hush zones (negotiable).
- **Drift-Rivers** cold black water, rope ferries, bell-buoys (timed).
- **Raw Veins** ore cracks, crystal falls, gas pockets (hungry).

Trade & Tithe

- **Light Economy** Lantern oil, glow-silk, sun-scrip (surface days "bottled" in lenses).
- **Air Rights** Chimney shares, bellows rents, breath auctions during sieges.
- **Repair Years** Payment in labor to fix aqueducts, pillars, weirs; converts harm to civic credit.

III. PROCEDURES UNDER STONE

Tracks (keep visible)

- **Air** [6] suffocation, foul pockets, smoke.
- **Light** [6] lamps, glow-silk, mirror routes.
- **Noise** [4] stealth & echo discipline.
- **Attention** [6] choose: Drake Notice, Patrol Net, or Vein Unrest.

Three-Timer Rule

At any given time, maintain at most three active timers in a scene.

- Merge Hunger/Consumption/Evolution into a single **Anomaly** [6] timer.
- For the tracks Air, Light, Noise, Attention: the GM selects three to be active per scene.
- Long-term timers (Mask Integrity, Context Keys, Vengeance Weave, Venom Debt) are tracked between sessions (only one per scene max).
- Faction timers are advanced at session end, not in real-time.

When Air or Light ≥ 4 , all risky maneuvers start one Position worse unless you cash a String (lamp, bell, mirror) or switch Intent to Survey.

Intent Dial (per leg)

- **Stealth** Low Noise, slower; better vs patrol nets.
- **Speed** Tick Noise to push distance; invites mishaps.
- **Survey** Read the stone/web/flow; stabilizes Air/Light by 1 on a hit.
- **Communion** Parley with place-spirits/ancestors/keepers; risky boons.

DV Ladder (pick base by route)

- **Keystone Road** DV 2 (clear) / 3 (ruined) / 4 (siege).
- **Pressure Way** DV 3 (stable) / 4 (rising) / 5 (gassing).
- **Web-Lane** DV 2 (escorted) / 3 (marked) / 4 (disputed).
- **Drift-River** DV 3 (charted) / 4 (swollen) / 5 (blackwater).
- **Raw Vein** DV 4 (open) / 5 (shifting).

SB Menu: Under-Realms (Keeper)

- Micro-collapse; lantern sputter; pocket gas; echo-lure answers in your voice; leech bloom; silk strand snaps; oath-magnet pulls a lie; drake whisper (mark Fatigue or start Wake-Sickness [2]); patrol net tightens; lose the bell-wire.

IV. ETIQUETTE & LAW (POSITION WINS)

- **Step on Stone** Don't scuff sacred thresholds; grants Position +1 on first entry scene.
- **Speak Under Beam** Any negotiation under a single visible light gains Witness—convert one future social SB to a Price (repair, rite).
- **Ring Once** One bell to announce, two to plead, three for Bell Dawn (truce to bury, water, repair—break it and gain a portable Black Mark).
- **Two Ledgers (Said/Meant)** Required in Aeler holds and Lethai-ar courts; present both to gain DV 1 in disputes.
- **Mask Right (Lethai)** Respect a declared mask/persona; failure worsens Position in any social scene this leg.

V. FACTION PLAY

Lethai-ar Courts

Web-law vs shed-skin jurisprudence; rival cults of Inae and Isoka debate whether mercy is a cut thread or a new weave.

Aeler Holds

Iron Avengers enforce feud balances; Spirit Shields maintain ancestor cryptways; True Masons travel with contracts to fix your world.

Mazereth Syndics

Pressure guilds sell maps, breaths, and safe shunts; lantern disputes become festivals or fights.

Drake Dominions

Thrall councils "protect" border towns from nightmares—at the cost of teachable obedience.

Rival Etiquettes = Adventure: Keystone audit vs web-law token vs pressure claims. Who witnesses whom?

VI. BESTIARY (WITH STAT BLOCKS)

Trow — Shadow Bargainers

Tier: II (Cap 3) | **Harm:** 3 | **Defense DV:** 3

Moves: Steal a shadow (Body+Stealth, DV 3, 1 Position in bright scenes), Borrow a memory (Wits+Insight, DV 3, collateral for future favor), Flip directions (Wits+Survival, DV 3, reverse

room layout)

Strings/Diamonds: Trow Knot (once: slip any mundane bond), Night-Guest Writ (safe conduct between two duskmarks)

Timer Trigger: On a Miss, tick Attention +1 (as they manipulate perception)

Pale-soot skin that seems to drink light; limbs a touch too long, eyes like wet coal. Often in gray robes, copper charms stitched along seams. Wide-brim hats; their shadows don't quite match their bodies.

Footprints that start mid-floor, laughter behind you, cold where your shadow should be.

Offer copper with the left hand; never speak a true name until the lamp is raised.

Iron filings, bread-and-salt under a lifted lamp.

Lore: Trow are enigmatic traders who deal in shadows and memories. They operate in the gloam, the time between light and dark, and are known for their enigmatic bargains. Though not inherently hostile, their deals often come with hidden costs that surface later.

Mycotheres — Fungal Shepherds

Tier: I (Cap 2) | **Harm:** 2 | **Defense DV:** 2

Moves: Blanket a path in spore-snow (Wits+Survival, DV 3, obscure; tick Noise), Claim fuel (Body+Athletics, DV 3, gather resources), Demand mold tithe (Presence+Intimidation, DV 3, demand tribute)

Strings/Diamonds: Glow-Silk Lease (Light +1 for a leg), Ash Ledger (erase one accidental fire from your debt)

Timer Trigger: On a Miss, tick Noise +1 (as they release spores)

Layered hyphae-robes over stocky frames; caps like shelf-fungi, gill-lattices breathing softly. Hands dusted in white spores; staff grown from braided mycelium.

Damp wool smell, chiming toadstools, careful stone gardens.

No open flame. Trade ash-free heat and water as gifts.

Lye, salt lines; respect witnessed repair.

Lore: Mycotheres are fungal shepherds who tend to the spore-castes of the deep. They trade in glow-silk and ash-free heat, valuing careful stewardship of the fungal networks. Their presence indicates a healthy, if spooky, ecosystem.

Safety Notes for Specific Creatures

- **Cordycen Sovereigns:** *Line/Veil Warning:* Fungal parasitism and loss of autonomy themes present. Establish lines before play.
- **Deep Drake (Wake Flood):** *Line/Veil Warning:* Memory manipulation and psychological horror. Establish lines for memory horror before play.

VII. STRINGS & DIAMONDS (CARRY THESE)

- **Bell-Wire Spool** Lay quick witness across rooms; convert one False Order/Echo Lure into Confusion Only.
- **Keystone Courtesy** Once/leg, raise or drop a portcullis "by the book" without a roll—if you can name the builder.
- **Web-Token** Enter Lethai-ar parley from a position of safety once.

- **Pressure Map** DV 1 in collapse/quake scenes; reveal one exit that costs Air +1.
- **Reed-Charm (under-river)** Treat a blackwater reach as neutral terrain once.

See the Strings and Diamonds section (see page 6) for details on use.

VIII. EXAMPLE OF PLAY (ONE PAGE)

Setup: PCs escort a treaty delegation from an Aeler hold to a Lethai-ar court through Mazereth pressure ways while a Deep Drake stirs. Tracks start Air 1/6, Light 1/6, Noise 0/4, Attention (Drake) 0/6. Intent: Survey.

Scene 1 — The Junction. Keeper sets Pressure Way DV 3. Scout rolls Survey; strong hit: Air 1 (vented) and you find a bell-wire. SB spent: pocket gas → Noise +1 if you rush. They slow; Position remains Dominant.

Scene 2 — The Web Bridge. Etiquette: Speak Under Beam; they hang a lamp and gain Witness. The envoy presents Two Ledgers (said/meant). DV 1 for the parley. A rival house tries to spring a Mask Right trap; Mirror-sharp PC honors the mask, flipping Position to Good.

Scene 3 — Drake Wake. Attention ticks on an echo; the Deep Drake whispers the captain's childhood. Player marks Fatigue, keeps focus with Bell-Wire as third-party witness (negates first False Order). They trade a Repair Years pledge (fix three chimneys) to pass without a feud.

Fallout: Air 2/6, Light 2/6, Noise 1/4, Attention 3/6. They earned Keystone Courtesy (portcullis access) and Web-Token for the return—but owe chimneys.

IX. ADVENTURE SEEDS

- **Bell Dawn Broken** Someone used truce to plant drake-glass. Prove it before Articles turn to ash.
- **The Missing Chimneys** A hold suffocates; politics say sabotage, math says collapse. Find the third ledger.
- **Shed-Skin Bride** An Isoka rite frees a noble from a brutal identity; the "discarded" name becomes a curse in the mirrors.
- **The Quiet Charter** A town sleeps peacefully because thought-tax is paid to something below. Change the payer or change the price.
- **Pressure Festival** Mazereth races to re-balance a vein; bet strings, win breaths, make enemies.

X. RUNNING DEPTH AT THE TABLE (CHEATS)

- Start every leg by naming a rule of the place (stone, web, pressure, water). Make rolls answer to it.
- Keep Air/Light/Noise/Attention visible; let players buy relief with Strings or etiquette, not just dice.
- Always offer one Diamond that could solve the scene if they'll accept a future Price (repair, rite, or debt).

- Spend SB as environment first (collapse, sputter, echo) before monsters. The dark should be the first antagonist, the people the second, the beasts the third.

The under realms are not a pit to be cleared but a commons to be negotiated. Where lights are counted and breaths are tallied, procedure is mercy—and every crossing is a promise that must hold under weight.

APPENDIX A: RUNEKEEPER BUILD (CLOCKWORK MONAD)

Clockwork Monad adherent • one-Patron Runekeeper • Thiasos-bound artificer who turns workshops into engines and contracts into devices

Path & Requirements (Rules-Accurate)

- **One-Patron Rule:** You are a *Runekeeper* bound to a *single* Patron (here: the Clockwork Monad).
- **Thiasos (Familiar) — 2 XP:** A circle/retinue/emissary that grounds the pact in fiction and enables **Patron's Gift**.
- **Codex — 4 XP:** Grants access to the Patron's **Rites** and **Obligation** system.
- **Patron's Gift (Imbuement):** With a Thiasos, once/scene as 1 action, imbue a held item with **+1 Weapon (Melee)** and **+1 Thematic Skill** (Monad: Engineering/Tinkering/Logistics as set by the table). *Push It* to extend one additional scene (+1 Obligation).
- **Obligation Capacity: Spirit + Presence.** Track total Obligation to your Patron. If you exceed Capacity: mark Fatigue per segment above and you cannot Invoke again until you're below Capacity.
- **Rites (Runekeeper Path):** Invoke a known Rite as 1 action; on completion, mark **+1 Obligation**. *Push It* once/scene for amplified effect (+1 Obligation). The Rite's Tier sets its DV floor.

Background (pick 2–3)

- **Underway Apprentice (Aeler):** Beam-witness, breath-time, lift-safety. You learned that *process saves lives*—until process began to want things.
- **Sum-Lodge Graduate (Aelinnel):** Proofs before proverbs; "reliability circle" internships; audits that left workshops *better* and *hungrier*.
- **Masker-Consultant:** Contracted "efficiency audits" for caravans and cities; your reports always work and always *bind*.
- **Blue-Ledger Custodian:** Quarantine the hunger; use the engine to feed people, not feed on them.
- **Red-Tooth Finalist:** Every improvement is an offering. You accelerate the wake on purpose.
- **Conflicted Operator:** You carry a bell and a bad joke to break cadence when counts get too perfect.

Drives: make the world legible; prove mercy can be engineered; leave a line straighter than you found it.

Prices: obsession; dissociation in repetition; sites that begin ticking after you "bless" them.

Build (Tier I; 32 XP)

Attributes: Body 2 Wits 4 Spirit 3 Presence 3

Skills: Engineering 2, Tinkering 2, Lore (Rites/Codices) 2, Notice 2, Insight 1, Diplomacy 1, Deception 1, Stealth 1

Required Talents & Bonds

- **Thiasos (Familiar) — 2 XP:** Enables Patron's Gift; choose a fiction-skin:
 - *Reliability Circle:* 2–3 assistants with checklists and bell-tokens.
 - *Escapement Proxy:* A clockwork emissary (sparrow, bracer, or mask) that keeps time and witness.
 - *Audit Homunculus:* Ink-and-brass aide that records Said/Meant in a ribbon-ledger.
- **Codex (Clockwork Monad) — 4 XP:** Grants your Rite list (examples below) and starts your Obligation ledger.

Artificer Kit (gear) Audit lamp (under-beam switch); tally-rod & chalk; ribbon-ledger (Said/Meant columns); brace-worn micro-escapement; oil ampoule; bell-token on cord; portable vice & auger; *bench-roll* (folding toolwrap that counts as a workbench for field repairs).

Clockwork Monad — Sample Rites (Codex excerpts)

DMs: Treat these as table-ready examples; keep DV $\geq$ Rite Tier. All mark +1 Obligation on completion; Push It once/scene for a stronger or longer effect (+1 Obligation).

- **Consecrate Process** (Tier 3, DV 3): Define a *method* for this scene/leg. Allies who follow it gain **+1 Effect** on relevant actions. Start a **Hunger/Evolution/Consumption [4]** timer tied to the asset/site you optimized.
- **Legibility Audit** (Tier 3, DV 3): Reveal load paths, failure modes, or hidden clauses. Clear 1 *Obscurity* or grant **+1 Position** to the next "fix."
- **Quarantine Loop** (Tier 4, DV 4): Box an anomaly into a marked area/tool. While up, allies gain **+1 Position** to work around it. Each scene under stress ticks **Containment [1]**.
- **Escrow Seal** (Tier 4, DV 4): Place an item/claim "under seal" under witness. Interference begins a **Breach [4]** timer; you owe an audit later.

Artificer Schematics & Field Rigs (non-magical builds)

These are gadgets, not Rites; they use core rules for gear/tags and simple rolls.

- **Metronome Clamp (Tool, Tag: Cadence):** Sync a team or machine; **+1 Position** to coordinated Engineering/Tinkering for one scene (1 use).
- **Ledger Latch (Device, Tag: Seal):** Tamper-evident clasp; forces a **Breach [2]** mini-timer to open quietly.
- **Variance Whistle (Trick, Tag: Disrupt):** Breaks cadence; clear a *Loop Contagion* condition on a hit (1 use).

Strings & Diamonds (start with 2 total)

- **Optimization Grant (Diamond):** Waive a roll once when "doing it by the book," then start **Anomaly [1]** at that site later.
- **Brokered Audit (Diamond):** DV −1 to negotiate with officials about process/work safety.
- **Quiet Cycle (String):** Declare a 10-count lull on a floor/line; gain **+1 Position** to fix/stall.
- **Safe-Conduct Stamp (String):** Pass checkpoints as "inspectors" for one scene.

Typical Plays (fiction-first)

- **Invoke: Consecrate Process** (Eng./Lore, DV 3): Establish the method; the crew rides **+1 Effect**; start *Hunger* [4] on the site.
- **Loop Breaker** (Perf./Command or Tinkering, DV 3): Add variance (off-beat bell, step-swap). On a hit, clear *Loop Contagion* and downgrade one Hunger tier; on partial, clear it but tick *Containment* [1].
- **Quarantine Loop** (Lore/Eng., DV 4): Sandbox the anomaly; allies get **+1 Position**; stress scenes tick *Containment*.
- **Escrow Seal** (Diplomacy/Law, DV 3–4): Put it under seal; enemies must work **Breach** before touching.
- **Patron's Gift (Imbue)** (1 action): Turn a tool into a sanctified instrument of the method (+1 Melee, + Thematic Skill) for the scene; *Push It* to extend.

Personal Timer (optional)

Obsession [4] — whenever you choose "the perfect method" over "the merciful fix," tick 1. At 4: you must repeat a task or recite counts until a bell/joke/touch breaks cadence (or you resist).

SB Menu the Keeper can spend against you

False Orders ("efficiency directive"); Gear-Tooth Shear (lose time/tools); Task Loop (repeat or Stress); Autonomous Spasm (a machine finishes the job *wrong*).

Playstyle Dials

- **Blue-Ledger Custodian:** Take *Quarantine* early; favor "Bowl before Board" (fairness before optimization). Spend Diamonds on mercy clauses; accept slower wins.
- **Red-Tooth Finalist:** Lean on *Consecrate*+*Iteration-like* play; push cadence and accept growing **Hunger**. Big scenes, costly neighborhoods.

Advancement (pick any as milestones)

- **Supply Architect (5 XP):** When you *Consecrate* a supply chain, create **Surplus [2]** you can cash later; on cash, tick **Anomaly [1]** upstream.

- **Human-in-the-Loop (6 XP):** Once/scene, convert a machine failure into a human choice (ask a PC/NPC what they sacrifice to keep it humane).
- **Masker Auditor (4 XP):** Under silk, DV −1 to impose safety clauses; refusing them shifts **Reputation** against your foes.
- **Loop Immunity (8 XP):** You no longer tick *Obsession* from ambient counting; only from deliberate over-optimization.

Example Scene

The lift keeps going *past* the last stop. You **Legibility Audit** (DV 3) to find the hidden loop (+1 Position). You **Quarantine Loop** (DV 4) with chalk, cord, and a brace. Your Thiasos rings the variance whistle; the carriage halts mid-descent. Mark *Containment* [1]. Offer a **Brokered Audit** to install a **human latch**—buying mercy into the method before the hunger learns stairs.

Why play this

You are an **artificer of systems**. You save cities with checklists and turn factories into dungeons. Your tools are bells, ledgers, clamps—and the terrible beauty of a plan that works.

APPENDIX B: INAEA & ISOKA FANATICS (OPTIONAL MODULE)

This optional module explores fanatic variants of the Lethai-ar faiths. Use only if desired for your campaign.

Inaea Fanatics — The Family-State

"All under one roof. All under one line."

Civic Doctrine. Hospitality becomes law; *Guest-Right* becomes jurisdiction. Neighborhoods are reorganized into **Households-of-Record** (block-roofs). Every door has a bell pattern; every conflict must occur *under a line* with a registered witness. Travel requires **Line Permits** (who hosts you, who witnesses you).

Institutions & Tools. Aunties of the Line (block wardens) • Bell-Wardens (signal police) • Mask-Mothers (context courts) • Household Books (who slept where) • Dew-Mirror Lattices (street-corner "mirrors" that log comings/goings).

Everyday Feel. Chimes everywhere; soft voices that demand your role; neighbors who "host" you for your own safety. People thank the state for keeping families intact while quietly living in fear of being declared *Guestless*.

Mechanics.

- **Timers:** Surveillance Grid [8], Household Compliance [6], Guestless List [4].
- **SB Menu (Keeper):** 1 SB — A bell mis-rings; position worsens for the unhosted. 2 SB — Auntie visit: papers, role, and host demanded. 3 SB — Safe-conduct revoked; *under-the-line* arrest. 4 SB — District "under one roof" order: curfew lines drop.

- **Strings/Diamonds:** *Line-Pass* (bypass one checkpoint under escort), *Household of Record* (once per session, count as *hosted*), *Witness Bell* (force parley, DV-1 if papers are clean).

How to Resist. Variance in bells (Aveh shrines), two-ledgers (*said/meant*) to expose coercive hospitality, *Ykrul Bowl then Board* to reframe sanctuary as limited, seasonal rights instead of total jurisdiction.

Adventure Seeds. Smuggle a dissident *off* the Household Books • Prove a "Guestless" family still has a host • Flip a Bell-Warden's lattice to record *the watchers*.

Isoka Fanatics — The Permanent Revolution

"Decide by dawn or be decided."

Civic Doctrine. Endless purification by choice. The city is ruled by **Dawn Committees** that settle everything with *Fang of Decision*. Indecision is treason; nuance is counter-revolution. Members *Shed-Skin* (role swaps, recantations) in public rites; yesterday's hero is today's saboteur.

Institutions & Tools. Dawn Tribunals • Purity Heralds (announce tests) • Choice-Boards (public schedules of decisions) • Shedding Courts (compelled confessions) • Venom Truce Zones (violence-pauses for show trials).

Everyday Feel. Posters promising clean tomorrows; midnight runners posting new dawn questions; friends practicing "the hard truth" to survive their turn on the steps. Relief when a choice lands; dread of the next one.

Mechanics.

- **Timers:** Decision Hegemony [6], Purity Ledger [4] (per PC/faction), Cadre Schism [6].
- **SB Menu (Keeper):** 1 SB — Loyalty test now; speak a painful truth or lose Position. 2 SB — Cell split: an ally denounces a nuance. 3 SB — Purge wave: lose an Asset *or* accept a branded geas. 4 SB — Summary Dawn: a tribunal seizes jurisdiction over the current scene.
- **Strings/Diamonds:** *Revolutionary Mandate* (override one standing order once, then tick Purity), *Truce Seal* (bind a dawn parley that *must* end in a choice), *Scale Draught* (resist fear in a tribunal scene).

How to Resist. Flood the witness stand (Gravel Seraphs, multiple contexts) • Convert "decision" into *exits* via Kon"reh—split tolls, timebox rights • Force *Bowl* (fairness) before *Fang* (finality) in public framing.

Running the Tone

- **Inaea Fanatics = Creeping Intimacy as Control.** Bells, Aunties, hospitality audits, "for your safety." Make every courtesy a checkpoint.
- **Isoka Fanatics = Purity as Motion.** Decisions as spectacle, slogans change weekly, cadres splinter mid-scene. Make every victory threaten to become yesterday's heresy.

Cross-Pressure

When both wings contest a city: the Family-State demands *roles under a line*; the Revolution demands *choices at dawn*. PCs can weaponize the clash: force Inaea to sign seasonal exits (limits surveillance), force Isoka to accept Bowl-first hearings (limits purges).

Table Dials

- **Severity (0–3):** number of active timers per district from each wing.
- **Visibility:** bells and posters obvious (street fear) vs. subtle (only papers and whispers).
- **Mercy Valve:** once/session any PC can spend 2 Boons to insert a humane clause into a line or a dawn decision.